Afonso Lobo Palmeira

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Summary

International Master's in Management candidate at Nova SBE, combining a Computer Science background with global enterprise consulting, AI-driven product development, and consumer entrepreneurship. Track record includes founding an AI-powered SaaS platform, building a consumer brand serving 4,000+ customers, and managing enterprise cases with 9.2/10 customer satisfaction.

Education

Nova School of Business and Economics Sep 2026 – Expected Jan 2028
*International Master's in Management — **Financial Times #2 worldwide, 2026*** *Carcavelos, Portugal*

Instituto Superior Técnico — University of Lisbon Sep 2021 – Jun 2024
Bachelor of Science — Computer Science and Engineering *Lisbon, Portugal*

Experience

Trinca e Molha Mar 2025 – Present
Founder & Business Lead *Oeiras, Portugal*

- Conceived and launched a consumer food brand with two co-founders, leading pricing, multi-supplier management, logistics, staffing, and execution across pop-ups and private events; achieved **101.5% ROI on total invested capital**.
- Served **4,000+ customers in the first 15 days** and built an annual customer base of approximately **6,000**, generating **300K+ social media reach**.
- Invited by **IPAM**, a leading Portuguese marketing school, to deliver a guest talk and launch a live student challenge on consumer insight, product innovation, and growth.

Cisco Systems Sep 2024 – Aug 2026
Technical Consulting Engineer *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Managed up to **three new enterprise cases daily** for customers worldwide, including high-priority security incidents, while maintaining a **9.2/10 customer satisfaction score**.
- Translated complex customer requirements into actionable solutions, coordinating with client stakeholders and cross-functional engineering teams across global accounts.
- Built internal productivity tools, surfaced recurring customer insights for product teams, and mentored a new joiner through technical onboarding and case management.

Arli Aug 2025 – Aug 2026
Co-Founder & Product Lead *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Co-led a **two-person founding team** building an AI-enabled construction cost-simulation platform from concept to production; selected for Unicorn Factory Lisboa's Contech acceleration programme.
- Engaged **150+ construction companies** to validate customer needs and willingness to pay, translating market feedback into product and go-to-market decisions.
- Designed a recurring SaaS and transaction-fee business model; discontinued the venture before scaling after market validation showed insufficient willingness to pay.

Sky Jul 2024 – Aug 2024
Frontend Developer — Summer Internship *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Owned the end-to-end delivery of an upselling feature within a **six-person Scrum team** across Peacock, Showmax, and SkyShowtime, including platforms serving **30M+ users**.
- Delivered responsive customer journeys across devices and resolved production issues ahead of launch during an eight-week internship.

Gorilla Project Oct 2021
Founder & Developer *Lisbon, Portugal*

- Built and sold a B2B automation tool covering every Portuguese national-exam subject.
- Deployed center-wide and still in use, saving **200+ staff hours annually** and contributing to approximately **180% website traffic growth**.

Leadership & Volunteering

Just a Change | Volunteer Construction Coordinator Summers 2025 & 2026

- Returned for a second two-week volunteering programme after completing a full home renovation in Sabugal in 2025; promoted to coordinate the 2026 intervention in Ansião.
- Led a **six-person volunteer team** through the full renovation of a home in a remote community, allocating daily work and coordinating execution under tight time and resource constraints; initiative featured in Público.

AEIST — Instituto Superior Técnico Students' Association | Corporate Relations Sep 2022 – Jun 2023

- Sourced corporate partnerships and sponsorships for **10+ student events annually**.
- Secured commercial backing for flagship events including Arraial do Técnico and Santa Sebenta, attracting approximately **15,000 attendees each**.

Languages & Technical Skills

- **Languages:** Portuguese (Native), English (Proficient)
- **AI & Technology:** Advanced use of AI tools, LLM APIs, connectors, plugins, and workflow integrations; Python, SQL, TypeScript
- **Sports:** Rugby, tennis, and competitive football (former team captain)